

# Philipp Hilbert. *Platform PM building API marketplaces from zero.*

*Positioning.* Product leader with 13 years shipping 0-to-1 platforms, ready to define, package, and commercially launch the HTS API Marketplace.

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Dear Hopper Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the Principal Product Manager role for the HTS API Marketplace. The mandate, define what the marketplace is, own the commercial model, and build the developer experience from scratch, matches the kind of work I have done repeatedly, most recently as a solo founder building a two-sided B2B marketplace in construction staffing and before that shipping the Claims Center at EMIL Group from concept to production. Zero-to-one is not a phase I have observed; it is a mode I have operated in.

The specific challenge you are describing is a packaging and commercialisation problem layered on top of existing technical capabilities. The underlying systems, connectivity orchestration, pricing and sort, content mapping, exist. What the marketplace needs is someone who can translate those capabilities into externally-consumable API products with coherent pricing, clear onboarding, and a commercial model that scales. At Kvitt Payment Solutions I built a P2P fintech product from zero that was subsequently acquired and operated inside the Sparkasse girocard ecosystem. At EMIL Group I restructured a failing 18-person delivery organisation and shipped a claims product that had no prior precedent, both required exactly the cross-team coordination, commercial framing, and developer-facing documentation discipline you are asking for here.

On the AI-native working style: I prototype before I write PRDs. For construct8, my current side project, every workflow, matching logic, onboarding, funnel analytics, was first mocked with Claude Code or Lovable and validated with real users before engineering touched it. I use SQL for funnel and conversion analysis as a daily habit, not a once-a-quarter exercise. For the HTS Marketplace specifically, I would reach for a mock API catalogue and a clickable partner onboarding flow in week two, well before a sprint is planned, so that the capability PMs and the commercial team are reacting to something real rather than a slide.

The platform economics question, take rate structure per capability, platform vs. variable fees, the custom deals framework for large partners, is one I find genuinely interesting. My background spans fintech at Kvitt, B2B SaaS at EMIL, and public-sector data platforms at Bundesagentur für Arbeit, all of which required modelling unit economics and making pricing decisions that balanced partner incentives against platform sustainability. Owning the marketplace revenue P&L and tracking GBV and per-capability take rates alongside Finance is a scope I am built for.

The travel commerce domain is new to me, I have not previously shipped lodging or car inventory products. What I bring instead is a demonstrated ability to learn technical domain constraints fast (I came into defence AI and into insurance SaaS both as an outsider and shipped in both within weeks), and a transferable fluency in marketplace mechanics, API product design, and enterprise partner management. I would rather name that honestly than overstate a match.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

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